What the raiding team of the SIT found was a Tamil-to-English dictionary. When opened, they found a cavity inside that could conceal a pistol. It was immediately confirmed with the recovery of fifty-three live rounds for a 9 mm gun, an artificial eye made of glass, some eye-cleaning liquid, a notebook and two small diaries. The content of the diary gave them telephone numbers, addresses, code names and details of payments, which didn't make much sense to the SIT initially. There was a passport with the diaries that turned out to be of one Suthenthiraraja, aka Raja.

Further investigation revealed that Raja was none other than Santhan, who had played a vital role in the Padmanabha assassination and then in killing Rajiv Gandhi. For Sivarasan, he would pass information from one cadre to another; he would carry cash and distribute it among them; he would handle relocation of operatives between hideouts; and he would arrange meetings and carry instructions from Sivarasan to others. He had a sharp mind and knew what his boss wanted. It could be debated that he was of greater significance than Murugan as far as Sivarasan was concerned, although Murugan had played a deputy's role in the assassination of the former Indian Prime Minister.

Athirai confirmed Suthenthiraraja (who later turned out to be Santhan) was the same person who had moved her out of Aunty's house in Royapettah to another in Meenambakkam. But she didn't have its address. All she could remember was that she had crossed the airport. And that there were two girls in the house Suthenthiraraja was operating from—she gave the SIT their names, their class and what their school uniforms looked like. Armed with those details, the SIT found the address of the house quickly enough from the school authorities.

In an early-morning operation, Verma, Ragothaman and the Black Cat commandos nabbed Raja while he was fast asleep. He tried to reach his cyanide pill kept under his pillow but was quickly overpowered by the Black Cats. He was brought to Malligai. His interrogation began with the excitement of catching probably the last obstacle in their path to Sivarasan. One puzzle had been solved—Santhan was Suthenthiraraja, who was also Raja.